INCH-POUND

A-A-55113
7 JANUARY 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HANDBAG, WOMEN'S: SYNTHETIC, BLACK

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to MIL-H-43981.

ABSTRACT

Abstract. The simulated leather handbag shall be of one type, intended for use by female personnel of the US Army (Class 1) and Air Force (Class 2).

Classification. The handbag shall be of the following classes as specified:

Class 1 - Handbag with brass hardware
Class 2 - Handbag with chrome hardware

SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

General Description. The handbag is rectangular in shape with three separate inside compartments and a shoulder strap that is both removable and adjustable. The gage of stitching between the outermost rows of the shoulder strap shall be 3/4 inch and the gage between the inner rows shall be 5/16 inch. An interlock stitch shall be used. The bag is lined with bengaline, and the center compartment lining has a pocket with a slide fastener closure. The bag has an outside back pocket lined with bengaline, and the handbag is closed by means of a twist lock and flap plate.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FSSD, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101-8419, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A

FSC 8445

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Material.
Base fabric. The base fabric prior to coating shall be a black, 5 harness cotton sateen woven cloth, napped on one side, weighing 7.0 to 7.8 ounces per square yard with a minimum of 60 yarns per inch in the warp and 56 yarns per inch in the filling.

Coated fabric. The base fabric shall be coated on the napped side only with a polyurethane suitable compound and pigmented black in color. The coated fabric shall be embossed with a simulated leather grain and shall match the standard sample for color, grain and finish. The coated fabric shall conform to the following:

Characteristic	Requirement (Minimum)	Test Method
Weight (ozs./sq. yd.)	10.0 to 12.0	ASTM-D 3776 (Option C)
Breaking Strength (pounds)		ASTM-D 5034 (Grab Method)
Warp	60	
Filling	70	
Tearing Strength (pounds)		ASTM-D 1424
Warp	5.5	
Filling	2.6	
Adhesion of coating (pounds/2 inch width)	17	5970 of FED-STD-191

Lining material. The cloth for the inside lining and center zipper pocket shall be a black rayon warp/cotton filling bengaline. The warp yarn shall be a continuous multifilament viscose, and the filling yarn shall be a combed cotton. The finished cloth shall conform to the requirements specified below. As an alternate, the cloth for the lining and zipper pocket shall be either a 2 up, 1 down twill, or a plain weave, color black, consisting of 100% staple or texturized filament polyester, or a staple polyester and cotton blend of not less than 47% polyester, or a staple polyester and staple rayon blend of not less than 47% polyester. The finished cloth shall conform to the following:

Characteristic	Requirement (Minimum)	Test Method
Bengaline lining:		
Weight (oz./sq. yd.)	5.0	ASTM-D 3776 (Option C)

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Characteristic	Requirement (Minimum)	Test Method
Breaking Strength (pounds)		ASTM-D 5034 (Grab Method)
Warp	100	
Filling	65	
Yarns Per Inch (ends/inch)		ASTM-D 3775
Warp	140	
Filling	32	
Colorfastness to Crocking	Grade 3	AATCC 8 1/
Alternate lining:		
Weight (oz./sq. yd.)	4.3	ASTM-D 3776 (Option C) 2/
Breaking Strength (pounds)		ASTM-D 5034 (Grab Method)
Warp	72	
Filling	55	
Yarns Per Inch (picks/inch)		ASTM-D 3775
Warp	73	
Filling	46	
Colorfastness to Crocking	Grade 3	AATCC 8 1/

1/ AATCC Chromatic Transference Scale.
2/ A 15% minus tolerance will be permitted for 100% polyester cloth.

Interlining material. The felt (acetate, cotton or polyester) interlining shall weigh 3.0 to 5.0 ounces per square yard when tested as specified in test method ASTM-D 3776 (Option C), and shall have a thickness of 0.051 ± 0.015 inches when tested as specified in test method ASTM-D 1777 (at 0.6 psi.).

Paperboard. The paperboard used for stiffening shall be made from high-alpha cellulose wood pulp fiber impregnated with 25% ± 5% blended neoprene. The paperboard shall show a thickness of 0.035 ± 0.003 inches, a weight of 90 ± 5 pounds per 1000 square feet, a minimum bursting strength of 139 pounds per inch, and stiffness - in the machine direction of 280 ± 70 gram-cm, and in the cross direction of 120 ± 30 gram-cm, when tested as specified according to the following TAPPI test methods: T-411 for Thickness, T-410 for Weight, T-403 for Bursting Strength, and T-489 for Stiffness.

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Bogus Paper. The bogus paper used for lining component parts shall be made from wood pulp fibers. The shade of the bogus paper shall approximate the shade of the coated fabric and shall show a thickness of 0.018 ± 0.002 inches, and a weight of 70 ± 4 pounds per 1000 square feet when tested as specified according to TAPPI test methods T-411 for Thickness and T-410 for Weight.

Adhesive. The material for bonding coated fabric, fabric, and paper shall be a natural rubber or neoprene rubber solvent cement.

Thread. The thread for all inside and lining stitching, except for polyurethane components, shall be a 36/3 cotton count when tested as specified according to test method ASTM-D 1907. The color of the thread shall be Black Shade AA, C.A. 66043, of DoD Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades for Sewing Threads 1968.

The thread for stitching all polyurethane components shall be a suitable 3 ply spun nylon sewing thread averaging 6000 to 8000 yards per pound when tested as specified according to test method ASTM-D 1907. The color of the thread shall be Black Shade AA, C.A. 66043, of DoD Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades for Sewing Threads 1968.

Metal Parts.
Loop rings. The loop rings used for attaching the shoulder strap to the center pocket side loops shall be a commercially acceptable 0.160 to 0.165 inch diameter steel wire, 1-3/8 inches in length by 7/16 inches in width, approximate inside dimensions. The finish for class 1 shall be 0.0001 to 0.0003 inch nickel plate, followed by flash brass plating, coated with a baked lacquer finish. The finish for class 2 shall be 0.0002 inch minimum nickel plate, followed by a 0.00001 inch minimum bright finish chromium plating.

The double loop ring used for adjusting the shoulder strap shall consist of two commercially acceptable oval rings, of 0.1055 to 0.135 inch diameter brass wire, 7/8 inches in length by 3/8 inches in width, approximate inside dimensions. The rings shall be joined with a brass binder, 0.020 ± 0.001 inch in thickness, that shall hold the rings firmly together in a flat plane, and shall not disengage or rotate along its axis with normal thumb pressure. The finish for class 1 and 2 shall be a baked-on black semi-gloss enamel.

Twist lock. The twist lock and flap plate securing the front flap of the handbag shall conform to Fulford Manufacturing Company, Part numbers: 9086, 7781, 8989 and 8902, or a commercially acceptable equal. The finish for class 1 shall be 0.0001 to 0.0003 inch nickel plate, followed by flash brass plating, then coated with a baked lacquer finish. The finish for class 2 shall be 0.0002 inch nickel plate, followed by a 0.00001 inch minimum bright finish chromium plating.

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Base stop and stud. The base stops shall be brass half-ball, approximately 5/16 inches in diameter, with steel stud, conforming to Fulford Manufacturing Company, Part number 9526 and P-296 or equal. The dimensions of the base stop and stud shall be as shown on Figure 1.

Snap fasteners. The snap fasteners shall be an intermediate size, 4 part snap with a line 20 cap, and dull black chemical finish conforming to Scovill Fasteners Incorporated, Part numbers: Cap - 61-0100-0161; Socket - 61-0301-0161; Stud - 61-0258-0161; Post - 61-0345-0161; or a commercially acceptable equal.

Slide fastener. The slide fastener for the handbag pocket shall be a lightweight, nonseparating, nonreversible, brass chain or continuous element, monofilament polyester coil, with a short tab pull and no lock on the slider. The color of the tape shall be Black Shade G, Cable No. 66507, and the length shall be approximately 7 inches.

Finished measurements. The handbag shall conform to the following finished measurements:

a. Length shall be 10-1/4 inches ± 1/8 inch measured across the front of the handbag 1-1/4 inches up from the bottom from outside to outside of the welt.

b. Height shall be 7-1/4 inches, + 1/4 inch, - 1/8 inch, measured on the front of the handbag one inch in from either end at the bottom, from the bottom to the top of the bag with the flap closed.

c. Width of the shoulder strap shall be 1 inch ± 1/8 inch.

d. Width of the flap shall be 6-3/8 inches ± 1/8 inch measured near the center of the flap from the bottom folded edge to the edge of the joining seam at the top, with the flap open and flat.

Label/Marking. A commercial type white non-woven material label shall be used measuring not less than 3 inches by 1-1/2 inches. The basic cloth shall consist of either spunbonded polyester made from 4.0 denier (.44 Tex) continuous filament white polyester fiber or 80/20 polyester/cellulose material, impregnated and coated with a permanent pigmented acrylic or nitrocellulose composition affixed by an appropriate acrylic or nitrocellulose resin. To position, center identification label from side edges with top of label 1/2 to 1 inch from finished top edge of handbag on front lining panel of center pocket and stitch around four sides through lining material and bogus paper. The label shall read from top opening of handbag to bottom end. Stitching shall not be through printing.

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Patterns. The government shall furnish a single size pattern. The pattern generally provides for a seam allowance of 1/2 inch for joining seams. Commercial patterns may be used in lieu of the government furnished pattern provided they conform to the cited design and finished measurement.

Workmanship. After completion, the finished handbag shall be thoroughly cleaned, and all loose thread and foreign matter removed.

Product Demonstration Model. When required, offerors shall submit samples of their intended production. The Product Demonstration Model will consist of units independently developed. Product Demonstration Models will be analyzed and evaluated by the government. Evaluation criteria and basis for award are contained in the solicitation. Product Demonstration Models will be retained by the government. One (1) Product Demonstration Model approved by DPSC under the resultant contract will serve as a manufacturing standard for the corresponding production items delivered under this contract. Offerors are advised that the Product Demonstration Model does not relieve the successful offeror of his responsibility to perform in accordance with the Commercial Item Description specified above.

QUALITY ASSURANCE

Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Examination. The handbag shall be inspected in accordance with ANSI/ASQC Z1.4, published by the American Society for Quality Control.

Visual Examination. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5. The lot size shall be expressed in units of handbags.

Defects. The handbag shall be examined for the following defects:

Color and finish: (Applicable to all components and assemblies unless otherwise indicated): Not as specified; area of synthetic leather with no finish or not proper embossed print; variation in color, shade, or texture of grain on exterior of handbag when flap is closed; raw edges of synthetic leather or bogus paper not stained as required; color variation in bag interior.

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Material defects and workmanship damages: Any hole, cut, tear, or scratch; uncoated area; coated cloth wrinkled, creased, blistered, cracked, or lumpy; any thinly coated area evidenced by light area or window.

Cleanness: Any permanent spot or stain on exterior of handbag; any permanent spot or stain on interior of handbag; thread not trimmed.

Component and assembly: Any component part required omitted; strap reversed; edge of bengaline lining exposed beyond coated fabric flap edge, up to 1/16 inch inclusive, or more than 1/16 inch; bottom edge of flap not centered on front pocket when closed, up to 1/8 inch inclusive, or more than 1/8 inch.

Seams and stitchings: Accuracy of seaming - any part of handbag caught in unrelated operation or stitching; stitching overlapped less than three stitches on label, or less than 1/2 inch on all other stitching; various shades of thread used on outside of same handbag; puckering or pleating on interior or exterior of handbag; needle chews; any row of stitching omitted; stitching margin not as specified or irregular; any open seam. Gage of stitching and seam allowances: irregular, i.e., unevenly gaged or corresponding stitching not uniformly gaged; width not as specified or not within range of gage specified or varies more than 1/16 inch when no range is specified; seam or stitch type not as specified. Stitch tension: loose tension, resulting in a loose seam or exposed loops of top or bottom thread; tight tension resulting in cutting of material or thread breaks when strain is applied in the direction of the seam or stitching.

Hardware: Broken or malformed; corroded areas, burrs, or sharp edges; finish omitted or not as specified; improperly set, reversed, not attached securely, or failing to serve intended purpose; finish not smooth; contains scratches, streaks, or other visible defects, clinched tightly cutting the fabric.

Label: Not positioned as specified; missing, incorrect, or illegible.

Dimensional Examination. The finished handbag shall conform to the dimensions specified. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of handbags. The sample unit shall be one handbag; the inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Packaging Examination. The fully packaged shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with defects listed below. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

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Examination	Defect
Marking (exterior or interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling.
Content	Number of handbags per shipping container is more or less than required.
Palletization	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
	Pallet type not as specified.
	Load not bonded as specified.

Regulatory Requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

PACKAGING

Preservation, Packing, and Marking. The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

NOTES

Standard sample. For information and access regarding the availability of standard samples of shades specified, address inquiry to the procuring activity issuing the invitation for bids.

Source of Government documents. Copies of Military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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Copies of Department of Defense (DoD) Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades for Sewing Threads 1968 is available from:

Color Association of the United States, Incorporated
200 Madison Avenue
New York, NY 10016

Sources of Non-government documents.

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables For Inspection By Attributes is available from:

American National Standards Institute
1430 Broadway
New York, NY 10018-3308

Copies of ASTM Test Methods are available from:

American Society For Testing and Materials
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187

Copies of AATCC Test Methods are available from:

American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists
P.O. Box 12215
Research Triangle Park, NC 27709-2215

Copies of TAPPI Test Methods are available from:

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry
Technology Park/Atlanta
P.O. Box 105113
Atlanta, GA 30348-5113

Custodians:
Army - GL
Air Force - 11

Review Activities:
Army - GL
Air Force - 82, 99

User Activity:
Air Force - 45

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:
GSA - FSS

Preparing Activity:
DLA - CT

Project No.
8445-0118

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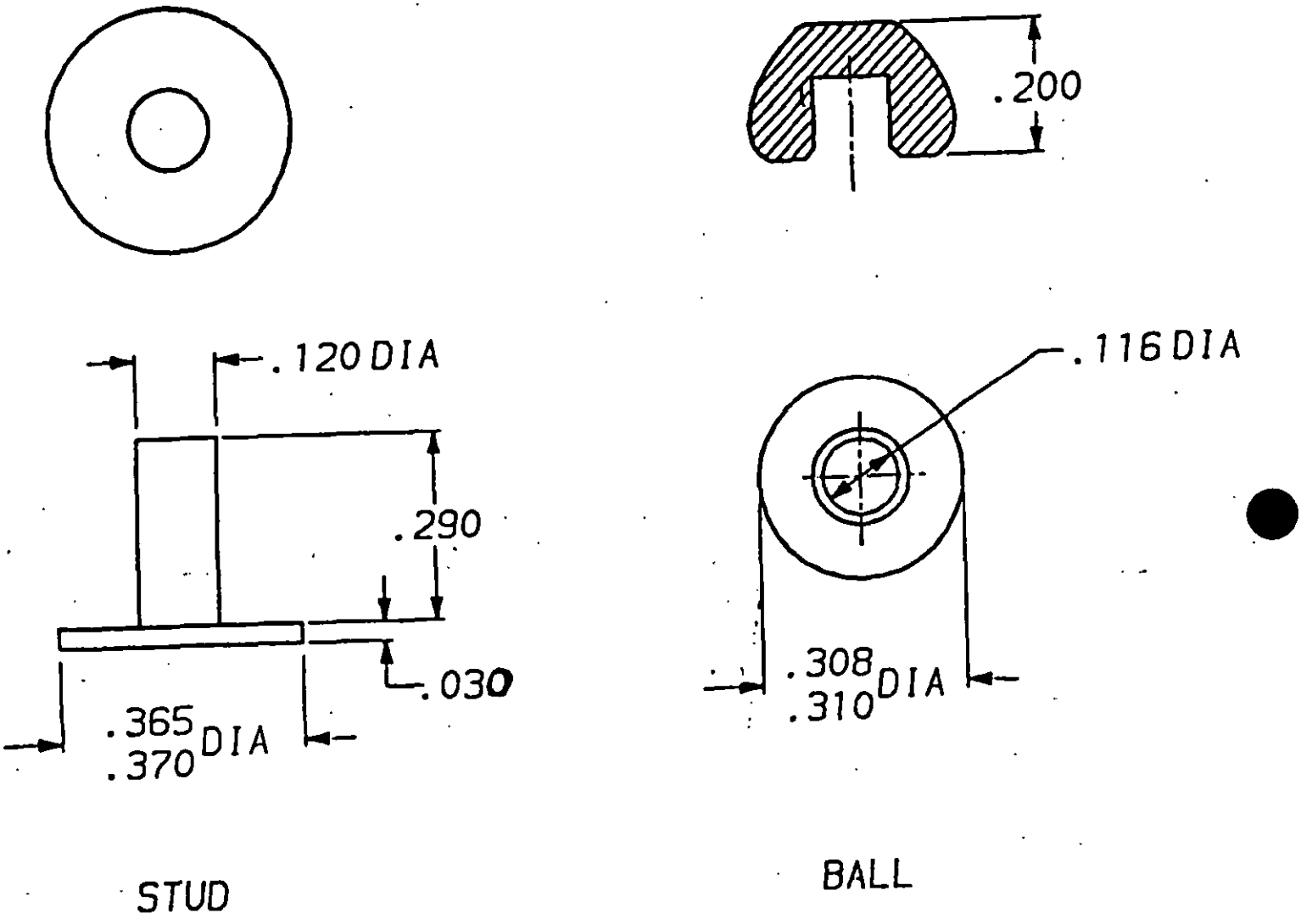


FIGURE 1. Handbag, Women's, Synthetic, Black

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INSTRUCTIONS

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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-55113	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 93/01/07

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
HANDBAG, WOMEN'S: SYNTHETIC, BLACK

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN: DPSC-FSSD (12-3-D) - DLA-CT	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial 215-737-8105	(2) AUTOVON 444-8105
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 South 20th Street P. O. Box 8419 Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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